

IT Security Policy

Effective Date: 1 April 2026 | Version 3.0 | Owner: IT Security Team

1. Purpose and Scope

This IT Security Policy defines the minimum security standards that all employees, contractors, and third parties must follow when accessing NovaTech Enterprises' information systems, networks, and data. It applies to all Company-owned devices as well as personal devices used to access Company systems under the Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) provisions described below.

2. Account and Password Security

- All Company accounts must use passwords of at least 12 characters, combining uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters.
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all access to email, VPN, cloud infrastructure, and the HRMS portal.
- Passwords must not be shared, written down in unsecured locations, or reused across personal and Company accounts.
- Accounts must be locked after 5 consecutive failed login attempts and can only be unlocked by the IT Helpdesk after identity verification.
- Employees must report any suspected compromise of their credentials to the IT Security team within 1 hour of discovery.

3. Device Security

All Company-issued laptops must have disk encryption, endpoint detection and response (EDR) software, and automatic screen-lock after 5 minutes of inactivity enabled at all times. Employees must not disable or attempt to circumvent any security controls installed by IT. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to the IT Security team immediately so that remote wipe procedures can be initiated.

Personal devices used under BYOD provisions to access Company email or documents must have a passcode enabled and must be enrolled in the Company's Mobile Device Management (MDM) system, which allows selective wipe of Company data without affecting personal data.

4. Data Classification and Handling

Company data is classified into four categories: Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted. Restricted data (such as client PII, financial records, and source code) requires the highest level of protection, including encryption at rest and in transit, and must never be transferred via personal email, unauthorized cloud storage, or removable media without explicit written approval from the IT Security team.

5. Network and Remote Access

Access to internal systems from outside the office network must be through the Company-approved VPN. Use of public Wi-Fi for accessing Confidential or Restricted data is discouraged; where

unavoidable, VPN connection is mandatory. Employees must not connect unauthorized personal routers, hotspots, or IoT devices to the Company office network.

6. Software and Application Usage

Only software approved and provisioned through the IT Asset Management system may be installed on Company devices. Use of unauthorized file-sharing tools, unlicensed software, or browser extensions with broad data-access permissions is prohibited. Requests for new software must be submitted through the IT Helpdesk portal with a clear business justification.

7. Email and Phishing Awareness

Employees must exercise caution with unsolicited emails, especially those requesting credentials, financial transactions, or urgent action. Suspected phishing emails should be reported using the 'Report Phishing' button in Outlook rather than being forwarded or replied to. All employees are required to complete mandatory annual security-awareness training, including simulated phishing exercises.

8. Incident Reporting

Any suspected security incident, including malware infection, unauthorized data access, or lost devices, must be reported immediately to security@novatechenterprises.com or via the 24x7 IT Security Hotline. Employees must not attempt to independently investigate or remediate a suspected breach, as this can interfere with forensic evidence collection.

9. Consequences of Non-Compliance

Violation of this IT Security Policy, whether through negligence or intentional misconduct, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, and in cases involving legal violations, referral to law enforcement. This policy is reviewed annually by the IT Security team and updated in line with evolving threats and regulatory requirements.